Infertility

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Abstract. Infertility treatments include medication, surgery, ART like IVF/ICSI, and lifestyle changes to boost fertility.

Published 2024-04-14 · https://microbiomemedicine.com/conditions/infertility · A Microbiome Signatures condition monograph

Overview

Infertility is a complex reproductive health issue, defined by failing to conceive after 12 months of regular unprotected sex. The criteria may differ depending on factors like age. The World Health Organization identifies it as a global public health concern, affecting about 17.5% of couples globally [x]. Conditions like endometriosis and erectile dysfunction can cause infertility. Identifying these causes is essential for effective treatment.

▶ **What female factors are associated with infertility?**

▶ **What male factors are associated with infertility?**

Diagnosis

Evaluating infertility involves complex, gender-specific diagnostic tests. In women, doctors assess ovulation, ovarian reserve, and the uterus and fallopian tubes' condition. They use hysterosalpingography, transvaginal ultrasound, and laparoscopy for these evaluations. For men, the primary diagnostic tool is semen analysis, which checks sperm count, motility, and morphology. Additional male tests may include hormone profiling, ultrasound exams, or genetic testing to detect underlying problems. This tailored approach precisely identifies infertility causes in couples seeking help.

Treatment

Infertility treatment depends on its cause, duration, partner ages, and personal choices. Options range from medication for ovulation and hormone balance to surgery for endometriosis and anatomical issues. If unsuccessful, Assisted Reproductive Technology (ART) like in vitro fertilization (IVF) and intracytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI) may follow. Lifestyle changes, including diet, exercise, smoking cessation, and reduced alcohol, can also boost fertility.

Implications

Infertility can have profound psychological and social impacts. It is often associated with stigma, emotional distress, and depression. Couples may experience stress in their relationship and personal anxiety. Hence,

psychological support and counseling are also integral parts of infertility treatment.

Research Feed

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Erectile Dysfunction
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Infertility
Infertility is the inability to conceive after 12 months of regular, unprotected sex. It affects both men and women and can be due to various physical, hormonal, or genetic factors. Treatments include medication, surgery, assisted reproductive technologies, and lifestyle changes.

Endometriosis
Endometriosis involves ectopic endometrial tissue causing pain and infertility. Validated and Promising Interventions include Hyperbaric Oxygen Therapy (HBOT), Low Nickel Diet, and Metronidazole therapy.

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